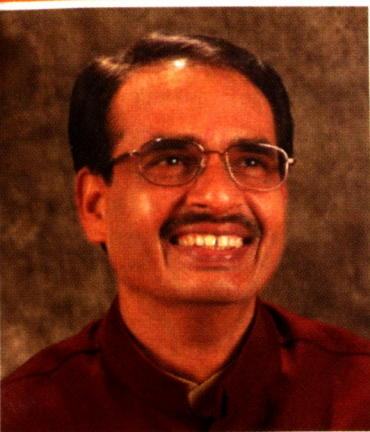




The present government was voted to power nearly four years back with a mandate to rejuvenate the development process in the state leveraging the rich natural wealth it is endowed with. The state government has given a commendably good account of itself over last four years, and living up to people's aspirations. These four years may, by every standard, be described as a watershed in the development history of Madhya Pradesh.

Especially notable is the implementation of power reforms in the state, an achievement that has earned praise and credit from the agencies like the World Bank.

Augmenting the transmission infrastructure

Again for the first time in the history of Madhya Pradesh a record of supplying the highest 6109 MW to the consumers has been set. Though a lot still remains to do to fully overcome the power crisis, but the indications are that Madhya Pradesh would become self-reliant in power sector soon.

While transmission capacity in the State till 2002-03 was only 3890 MW, within a short span of the 3 to 4 years 59% addition in the transmission capacity have been achieved. The present transmission capacity in the State is 6200 MW. For reducing reactive power requirement in transmission system, M.P. Power Transmission Company (Transco) has installed 150 MVAR capacitor banks on M.P. system. Whereas in the high losses areas, distribution franchisees have been encouraged to take up complete distribution supply works including maintenance of the system. Some of the distribution centers, few towns, and villages have already been awarded to the private distribution franchisees. Initial results of the distribution franchisees are encouraging.

Outsourcing of operation & Maintenance of some of the EHV and 33/11KV sub-stations has also been tried out successfully to improve services.

Encouraged by the excellent performance of the state in the power sector reforms front, Asian Development bank has sanctioned a second loan of US \$ 620 million for the state for strengthening transmission and distribution system and reduction in technical losses.

All round reforms in the sector

In its efforts to bridge the demand & supply gap in the sector, private participation is actively being pursued as a viable option. The State has adopted Merchant power plant concept and has signed MoU with 9 developers for 8800 MW capacity already. In order to encourage establishment of captive units, the cess has been rationalized and the same for existing units has also been reduced from 20 paise to 10 paise per unit.

The power sector reforms have been implemented in right earnest in the state. As many as 92 special courts have been set up for quick disposal of power theft cases. Meters have been fitted on all feeders of upto 11 kilowatt for energy audit. Over 37 lakh electronic meters have been installed on the

premises of consumers to check power theft and irregularities. In order to reduce billing cycle and for the facility to the consumers, spot billing has been started first time in the State in Bhopal city.

Facility of bill payment through bill desk (internet) has also been started in Bhopal city. Facility to intimate the details of electricity bills through SMS and email has been started in Jabalpur city.

Farmers installing meters have been exempted from minimum charge. A Rs. 2900 crore action plan would be implemented by end of the year to supply electricity upto the wells of farmers. An ombudsman has been appointed under M.P. Electricity Regulatory Commission for redressal of consumers' grievances.

Today Madhya Pradesh presents a pleasantly different picture of a state taking rapid strides on the road to self sufficiency in power and overall development. Proving yet again, that change can be effected in surprisingly short spans of time, all it requires is the vision, political will and above all, an honest commitment to the people.



Sh. L.K. Advani, Leader of Opposition, along with Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh, Sh. Shivraj Singh Chouhan along with others surveying Sanjay Gandhi Power Plant at Birsinghpur, Umana District

- Generation capacity addition of almost 2400 MW in three and a half years as against total 3000 MW addition in 56 years since independence.
- 24 hours supply to the industries throughout the year.
- 59% addition in the transmission capacity has been achieved.
- Asian Development bank has sanctioned a second loan of US \$ 620 million for the state for strengthening transmission and distribution system and reduction in technical losses.